

Indianapolis Vanishes Almost Without Trace

By THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

When the defending champion has been pretty well plowed under, most of its rivals think they have a better than fair shot at the new title.

This seems to be the situation in the American Assn., ready to open its 56th season of Triple-A baseball tonight.

The powerful Indianapolis Indians that won the pennant last season and then wrecked Rochester four straight in the Junior World Series has vanished from the league almost without a trace.

Last Manager

Indianapolis lost its manager, practically its entire ball club and its affiliation with the Cleveland Indians. It now is hooked up with the Chicago White Sox and has just two players left from the 1956 roster—outfielder Ted Beard and pitcher George Spencer. Andy Cohen is the new manager.

The opening night schedule has

Minneapolis at Indianapolis, Denver at Louisville, St. Paul at Wichita and Omaha at Charleston.

In the shuffle of players from the Association to the majors and back, the Denver Bears, runners-up last season, and the Minneapolis Millers, who wound up fourth, seem to have fared the best.

The Bears' attack again will be led by first baseman Marv Throneberry, who topped the league in 1956 in home runs with 42 and runs batted in with 145. Denver has two of its three outfielders from last year plus several experienced pitchers.

Such proven players as Carlos Paula, Hank Thompson, Eddie Bressoud and pitcher Jim Constable are with the Millers.

Indianapolis will open the season tonight after an all-day welcome ceremony.

The team was ready for a big downtown parade at noon. Frills at tonight's game will include a Dixieland jazz band.

Mike Halus Will

All Kinds of Sports